The Visual Analogue Scale

- The VAS is a simple robust pain measurement tool.
- It can be used to record pain severity and or improvement.
- It can be reliably used in children over the age of five.

The VAS is usually designed as a 10cm line, with descriptors at each end.

The VAS for PAIN severity

No Pain_____**Worst possible Pain**

The VAS for Treatment effect

No Pain_____**Complete Pain Relief**

The VAS is then scored by measuring from the patient's mark to the beginning of the scale in cms.

No Pain_____|____**Worst possible Pain**

The example shows a patient recording of 9
I.e. The patient has made a mark 9 cms from the no pain end of the scale.
Note – the VAS scale provides a quantitative measure of qualitative (subjective) pain experience